

SAMUEL FRAUSTO

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EDUCATION

University of Southern California Iovine and Young Academy for the Arts, Technology, and Business of Innovation	Los Angeles, CA
Junior, Bachelors of Science, Human Technology Interaction, 4.0 GPA	January 2025-May 2028
Franklin University Switzerland	Lugano, Ticino, Switzerland
Non-degree Seeking Student, 20 Units taken, 4.0 GPA	August 2024-December 2024

BISC 120/220: General Biology: Organismal Biology and Evolution/Cell Biology and Physiology

BISC 194: Introduction to Research II

CHEM 105: General Chemistry

ACAD 217: Extended Reality Development

ACAD 432: Collaborative Prototyping for Healthcare Innovation

ACAD 288: Constructing Digital Worlds

CSCI 103: Object Oriented Programming

MATH 126: Calculus II

RELEVANT PERSONAL/CLASS PROJECT WORKS

VR Baseball Training System (Independent)

- Using Blender for modeling and Unity for experience design, I am developing an interactive VR training system simulating pitch types, speed variation, and catcher scenarios
- Implemented ball physics, trajectory modeling, and real-time interaction mechanics

Portal-Based XR Experience (ACAD 217 Class Project)

- Engineered a portal system in Unity using render textures and secondary camera tracking to replicate player perspective
- Implemented spatial interaction mechanics and seamless environment transitions
- Optimized rendering and synchronization between player movement and portal visuals

Digital Twins – Iovine & Young Hall/Cyberpunk 2077 Room Render (ACAD 288 Class Projects)

- Built a virtual replica of a real-world environment for spatial exploration and simulation
- Modeled a high definition bedroom of the Cyberpunk 2077 game in the Omniverse
- Developed a custom Omniverse extension to streamline material transfer workflows

Crayola Promotional Video (Jel Sert)

- Produced and edited branded video content for a Crayola x Fla-Vor-Ice campaign, focusing on visual storytelling and audience engagement
- Worked directly with school district officials to get content approved of campaign media

Harley Davidson Homecoming Event Media Capturing (Jel Sert)

- Produced/edited promotional video from Pure Kick's partnership with Harley Davidson at their large Homecoming event

Company/Partner Newsletter (Jel Sert)

- Designed and produced internal and partner-facing newsletters to communicate brand initiatives and updates

Artificial Sweetener Formulation Research Project (Jel Sert)

- Tested and determined optimal formula combinations of an unused artificial sweetener on 4 company products

Stability Study Research Maintenance (Jel Sert)

- Tested the stability of 100+ products during my tenure in the Research and Development Lab, reporting the longevity of the products over time both on a shelf and in a controlled environment
- Used various devices and social tests to measure pH, gelatin penetration, color, and taste to determine a products stability

Micro-Immunology Cancer Research (UChicago)

- Spent 300+ hours on wetlab immunology epigenetic project "Evaluating Small Molecule Inhibition of TET2 to Overcome Adaptive Resistance to Radiation"
- Cultured CT:26 cell line to test effects of various drugs on adaptive resisting cells, post radiation
- Project inspired a second grant-winning project from a fellow lab member, which was later cut due to NIH grant funding cuts
- Presented poster at a cancer research symposium at the University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign in front of Faculty members from the top universities throughout Illinois, and received a second place presentation award of 36 presenters

AI vs. Expert Proteomics Research Project (Independent/UChicago)

- Collaborated with UChicago Proteomics Core Lead of 10+ years to compare the use of AI vs traditional methods when it comes to proteomic data sorting
- Analyzed 2100+ protein sequences in 80+ pathways to connect pathways that are up-regulated after ionization
- Presented results to my lab PI and lab mates at a weekly lab meeting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Jel Sert Company	West Chicago, Illinois
Research & Development Lab Intern	June 2024-August 2024
• Conducted experimental testing and data analysis to evaluate product performance and sensory outcomes • Led structured experimentation on flavor modulation systems, analyzing variable impact on user perception	
The Jel Sert Company	West Chicago, Illinois
Media & Communications Intern	June 2025-December 2025
• Developed and produced digital content across video and social platforms, integrating technical tools and workflows • Edited and delivered promotional media for major brand partnerships, focusing on execution and production quality • Identified opportunities to improve communication workflows and content strategy	
The University of Chicago	Hyde Park, Chicago, IL
ResearchHStart Fellowship Awardee	May 2023-July 2023
• Received a \$3,000 stipend to Conduct cancer research for four months in Dr. Stephen Kron's lab at the University of Chicago, focusing on my own immunology/epigenetic project • Took part in weekly workshops hosted by the UChicago Comprehensive Cancer Research Center, sitting in on 8+ lectures from medical professionals from a wide range of specialties and backgrounds • Worked and learned directly under Postdoctoral Fellow, who taught me the ins and outs of wet-lab work	

EXTRA CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

USC Club Baseball Team University of Southern California	Los Angeles, California
Programming Chair + Team Captain	January 2025-Present
• Compete against colleges nationwide, developing teamwork and leadership skills while balancing academics • Scheduled and managed both philanthropy and social events • Created series of videos/vlogs of the games while wearing a GoPro Camera while playing	

SKILLS

• Technical: Unity, C++, Python, Swift, Blender, R, VisionOS, NVIDIA Omniverse, Cursor/ChatGPT/Claude • Tools & Creative Software: Photoshop, DaVinci Resolve, Canva • Concepts: Interaction Design, Prototyping, Systems Design, UX Thinking	
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